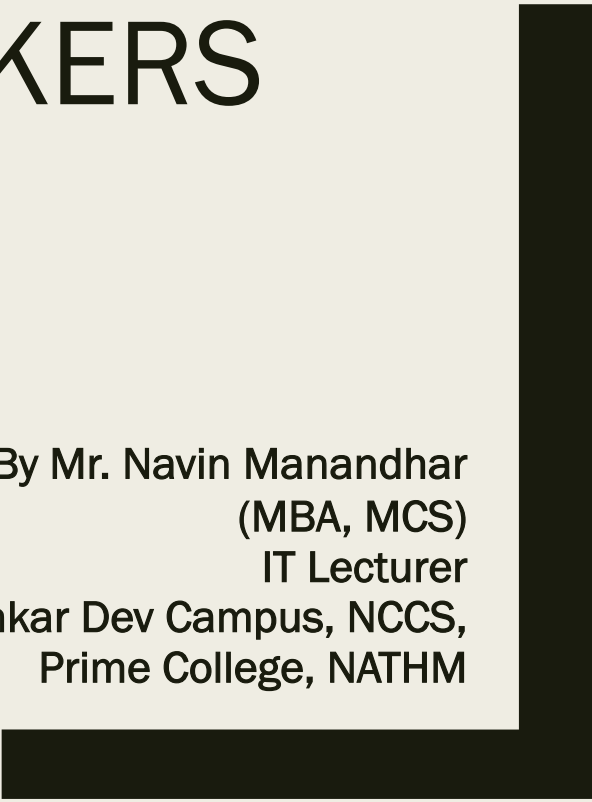




UNIT 2

ETHICS FOR IT WORKERS AND IT USERS

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Managing IT Worker Relationships

- Mutual relationship of IT workers with client, suppliers, stakeholders and other professionals are essential to build up mutual trust and respect
- Employees among IT fields like
 - *system analyst, developers, database admins, designers, frontend developers,*
 - *IT auditor, network administrator* *Quality Assurance must follow common guideline and have mutual respect to each other*
- **Clear Expectations:**
Employers must set clear job roles, performance standards, and ethical guidelines.
- **Conflict Resolution:**
Open channels of communication help resolve disputes and misunderstandings.
- **Fair Treatment:**
Avoid discrimination, ensure diversity, and follow labor laws.
- **Whistleblower Protection:**
Employees should feel safe reporting unethical behavior.

Relationships Between IT Workers and Employers

- IT workers and employers have a critical, multifaceted relationship that requires ongoing effort by both parties to keep it strong.
- An IT worker and an employer typically agree on the fundamental aspects of this relationship before the worker accepts an employment offer.
- These issues may include job title, general performance expectations, specific work responsibilities, drug-testing requirements, dress code, location of employment, salary, work hours, and company benefits.

Relationships Between IT Workers and Clients

- IT workers provide services to clients; sometimes those “clients” are co-workers who are part of the same company as the IT worker. In relationships between IT workers and clients, each party agrees to provide something of value to the other.
- IT worker provides hardware, software, or services at a certain cost and within a given time frame. For example, an IT worker might agree to implement a new accounts payable software package that meets a client’s requirements.
- The client provides compensation, access to key contacts, and perhaps a work space. This relationship is usually documented in contractual terms—who does what, when the work begins, how long it will take, how much the client pays, and so on.
- Although there is often a vast disparity in technical expertise between IT workers and their clients, the two parties must work together to be successful.

Encouraging Professionalism of IT Workers

- Use of basic principles: Confidentiality, Integrity and Availability
- Adherence to Codes of Conduct:
IT professionals should follow ethical guidelines, such as ACM or IEEE codes.
- Accountability:
Workers should take responsibility for errors and misconduct.
- Examples:
 - *Use of **Data Request Protocol** where Digital Marketing team submits a **formal data access request** specifying the **exact purpose** for which the data is required (e.g., personalized advertising campaigns or customer segmentation) to ensure sensitive information is handled in accordance with company values and legal standards.*

Encouraging Ethical Use of IT Resources Among Users

- **IT Policies:**

Clear policies define acceptable use of IT resources, such as company computers and internet access.

- **Education and Training:**

Teaching users about risks like phishing and malware helps them make better decisions.

- **Monitoring and Enforcement:**

Ensure compliance through monitoring tools, while respecting user privacy.

- **Examples:**

- **Unauthorized Software Use:**

Employees installing unapproved software may expose systems to malware.

- **Resource Overuse:**

Streaming media on company networks during work hours can reduce bandwidth for critical tasks.

Key Privacy and Anonymity Issues

- **Data Protection:**
Secure user data from unauthorized access and ensure compliance with regulations like GDPR.
- **Anonymity vs. Accountability:**
Maintain user anonymity where appropriate while ensuring accountability for harmful behavior.
- **Transparency:**
Clearly disclose data collection practices and obtain user consent.
- **Examples:**
- **Data Breaches:**
Companies like Facebook faced backlash for mishandling user data.
- **Government Surveillance:**
Controversies arise when governments collect user data without transparency.

Social Networking Ethical Issues

- **Privacy Concerns:**
Social platforms collect vast amounts of personal data, raising questions about user consent.
- **Cyberbullying and Harassment:**
Social networks must ensure safety by enforcing community guidelines to maintain data privacy and security
- **Misinformation:**
Platforms have a responsibility to combat the spread of false information which may have severe consequences influencing public opinion, inciting violence and trust issues.
- Addiction to health

■ Echo chambers and Polarization:

- *It refers to an environment often on social media or within a specific group where individuals are exposed primarily to information, ideas, or opinions that align with their preexisting beliefs.*
- *This lack of exposure to diverse perspectives reinforces their views, making them more rigid and resistant to change.*
- *On social media, if someone interacts primarily with posts supporting one political party, the platform's algorithm will prioritize similar content, reinforcing their existing political stance.*

Examples

- **Cambridge Analytica Scandal:**
Facebook data was misused for political profiling, highlighting the risks of lax data controls.
- **Redaction:** concealing or obscuring sensitive information from a document, image, or video before it is shared publicly. This can include blurring or blacking out text, images, or other identifying details.
- Redaction protects privacy, complies with legal obligations (like GDPR or HIPAA), and ensures that sensitive or confidential information is not inadvertently disclosed
- **Includes** Blurring license plates in photos, pixelating faces in group pictures.